

## Problem #2: Valman

### Solution:

The conjunction **and** in *Valman* agrees with the words it connects in *person*, *number* and *gender*. The root of the conjunction is **–a–**. The agreement makers are as follows (“left” means ‘to the left side of the conjunction’ and “right” means ‘to the right side of the conjunction’):

|                          |                                      |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| 1st person Singular      | <b>m-</b> (left), <b>p-</b> (right)  |
| 2nd person Singular      | <b>n-</b> (left), <b>ch-</b> (right) |
| 3rd person Singular masc | <b>n-</b> (left), <b>-n</b> (right)  |
| 3rd person Singular fem  | <b>w-</b> (left), NULL (right)       |
| 3rd person Plural        | <b>y-</b> (left), <b>-y</b> (right)  |

Note that **ch-** and **p-**, even though used as an agreement marker for the right argument appears before the root.

| Assignment                   | Answer      |
|------------------------------|-------------|
| the chieftain and you        | <b>ncha</b> |
| the guest and the hosts      | <b>nay</b>  |
| your neighbours and I        | <b>ypa</b>  |
| you and the guests’ wives    | <b>nay</b>  |
| my brother and the chieftain | <b>nan</b>  |
| me and the chieftains        | <b>may</b>  |
| grandmother and my wife      | <b>wa</b>   |

The same conjunction (**nay**) is used in the translations of the phrases *you and the guests’ wives* and *the guest and the hosts*, because the agreement markers for the 3rd person Singular masc and for the 2nd person Singular are identical: **n-** and **n-**.

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